Jinna Balu

Lead SRE • Platform Engineering • DevSecOps

Hyderabad, India

jinnabalu.com

jinna.baalu@gmail.com

GitHub LinkedIn

Value Ambassador Award — @ Wisestep, 2020 • Platform Engineering Role

PERSONAL PROFILE

Lead SRE with 12+ years of experience building and operating distributed systems, internal platforms, and reliability practices for global engineering teams. I architect and own infrastructure, CI/CD, observability, security, and data services, with hands-on ownership from design through production operations and a default focus on identifying toil and removing it.

SELECTED IMPACT

- Reduced AWS spend from **$27K/month** to **$12K/month** for a client environment through right-sizing, storage optimization, and infrastructure cleanup.
- Architected a centralized logging platform for **12+ data centers** processing **21M logs per hour** using application appenders, Kafka, Logstash, and Elasticsearch.
- Led a zero-downtime migration of a high-risk global traffic entry point from **Oracle Dyn** to **Cloudflare Load Balancer**, partnering with the team while driving the DNS and cutover strategy.
- Built deep hands-on expertise in **LDAP**, including multi-master deployments, migrations, productized management workflows, and open-source delivery through **LDAP Manager** and **OpenLDAP Docker**.
- Built **Docker Registry UI** as an open-source product with built-in **Trivy** image scanning for registry operations and security visibility.

WORK EXPERIENCE

SRE Lead • DevSecOps Architect — Aug 2022 – Present

- Owned platform architecture for **12+ data centers** running distributed services such as **Kafka**, **Cassandra**, **MongoDB**, **Solr**, and **ZooKeeper**.
- Eliminated legacy single points of failure by redesigning critical services into highly available, fault-tolerant multi-data-center systems.
- Led platform evolution from **DC/OS** (Mesos/Marathon) to **Kubernetes**, migrating workloads with **Helm** and improving long-term operability.
- Standardized regional high availability with **HAProxy**, **VRRP**, and **Keepalived**, then led the zero-downtime migration of the global traffic entry point from **Oracle Dyn** to **Cloudflare Load Balancer**.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Platform Engg
- DevOps
- DevSecOps
- Cloud
- SRE Practices
- Developer
- Team Management
- System Design

SKILLS

CLOUD SERVICES

AWS, Azure, Digital Ocean, IAM, S3, EKS, ECS, EC2, SES, AKS, AGIC, Audit Manager, Security Hub, Config, GuardDuty, Capacity Planning

CONTAINERISATION

Docker, Podman, Docker Swarm, Kubernetes, DC/OS, Mesos, Marathon, Helm

CI/CD & AUTOMATION

Jenkins, Bitbucket Pipelines, Remote Runners, GitLab, GitHub Actions, Ansible, Monorepo, Polyrepo

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

SOC2, GDPR, PCI DSS, SonarQube, SAST, DAST, Snyk, Trivy, Gitleaks, VAPT, Arachni, SPF, DKIM, DMARC

DNS & LOAD BALANCING

Caddy, NGINX, ALB, ELB, Cloudflare, HAProxy, Keepalived, VRRP

- Architected a centralized logging system for **12+ data centers**, routing application logs through local appenders to **Kafka**, then into central **Logstash** and **Elasticsearch**, sustaining **21M logs per hour**.
- Established infrastructure and uptime monitoring with **Datadog** and **Uptime Kuma** to improve operational visibility and incident response.
- Automated infrastructure and service delivery with **Ansible** across both containerized (**Docker**/**Podman**) and host-based environments, reducing deployment friction and manual toil.
- Introduced **Bitbucket Pipelines** with self-hosted **Remote Runners** as a modern CI/CD path and laid the groundwork for migration away from legacy **Jenkins** workflows.
- Strengthened production security by adding subdomain takeover controls and enforcing **SPF**, **DKIM**, and **DMARC** policies.
- Executed zero-downtime **LDAP** storage migrations (BDB to HDB to MDB), preserving data integrity and service continuity.
- Designed new cloud infrastructure on **Azure**, migrated workloads to **AKS**, implemented **AGIC v2**, and operationalized logging and monitoring agents as **DaemonSets**.
- Built internal platform products with **Amazon Q**, **Claude**, and **GitHub Copilot**, including:
  - A **Spring Boot** and **React** status platform with **Go**-based agents for global latency and synthetic monitoring.
  - A custom **LDAP Manager UI** built with **React**, **shadcn/ui**, and **Tailwind CSS** to simplify directory operations.
- Drove platform upgrades and infrastructure improvements that reduced operational toil and improved service reliability for globally used systems.

DevOps Manager — Apr 2021 – Jul 2022

- Led platform operations across **Docker Swarm**, **ECS**, and **Kubernetes** for application delivery and infrastructure standardization.
- Operated containerized **Cassandra**, **Elasticsearch**, **Kafka**, and **Redis** clusters with a focus on reliability, consistency, and scaling.
- Embedded compliance controls with **AWS Audit Manager**, **Security Hub**, and **Config** to support **SOC2** operations.
- Established observability-driven engineering with **Elasticsearch**, **Beats**, **Logstash**, and the **Prometheus** stack.
- Managed platform delivery using **Kanban** and **Scrum**, keeping error budgets, toil budgets, and operational overhead under control.
- Built and maintained a secure developer access center for internal services and operational workflows.
- Standardized ingress and traffic management using **NGINX** and **Caddy**.
- Automated CI/CD and infrastructure changes with **Git**, **Jenkins**, and **Ansible**.
- Scaled **Elasticsearch** without downtime or data loss while preserving disaster recovery paths with low **RTO** and **RPO**.
- Owned infrastructure automation, reliability, security, capacity planning, and change management with a lean team of 2.

MONITORING & OBSERVABILITY

ELK, Prometheus, Grafana, Beats, Logstash, Datadog, Uptime Kuma

DATA PLATFORMS

PostgreSQL, Cassandra, Elasticsearch, MongoDB, Redis, Kafka, Kafka Connect, RabbitMQ, Solr, Apache Nifi, Airflow

LANGUAGES & FRAMEWORKS

Java, Go, C#, Python, Spring Boot, FastAPI, React, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui, ASP.NET MVC, AngularJS

SCAFFOLDING & TOOLS

JHipster, Jekyll, Hugo, Yeoman

VERSION CONTROL

Git, Monorepo, Polyrepo, GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket

OPERATING SYSTEMS

Ubuntu, Mac, Windows

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Kanban, Scrum, Jira, Trello, Pivotal Tracker

AI-ASSISTED DEVELOPMENT

Amazon Q, Claude, GitHub Copilot

EDUCATION

MCA
JNTU Hyderabad, 2010 - 2013
CGPA 7.5 / 10

BSc, Computer Science
Osmania University, 2007 - 2010
CGPA 6.5 / 10

VOLUNTEER

Gramabharati

Gramavikas

Ekalavya Foundation

Platform Engineer — Wisestep Apr 2019 – Mar 2021

- Built and operated **Spring Boot** microservices on **AWS**, packaging services with **Docker** and improving release consistency.
- Automated deployments through CI/CD pipelines and structured change management practices.
- Established application and infrastructure monitoring for earlier fault detection and healthier releases.
- Managed distributed NoSQL and search clusters with attention to consistency, availability, and operational stability.
- Improved platform resilience across security, performance, and reliability concerns.
- Implemented application performance monitoring and real-user monitoring to improve visibility into customer experience.
- Applied **AWS** security and cost-optimization practices to production environments while building a stable operational baseline from scratch.
- Ran vulnerability assessments using open-source tooling and improved release readiness.
- Partnered with product engineering on release management and feature lifecycle delivery for the Wisestep recruitment platform.
- Acted as the primary infrastructure decision-maker at Wisestep, building the platform from the ground up without an established guide and iteratively shaping it into a stable, cost-conscious production system.

Product Development Engineer — Wisestep Sep 2014 – Mar 2019

- Built and supported business-critical applications across product engineering, backend workflows, and customer-facing features.
- Translated product requirements into UI, backend, and reporting enhancements with end-to-end ownership.
- Delivered application code, structured releases, and maintainable implementations across evolving product modules.
- Developed reports and analytical workflows to support operational and business decision-making.
- Contributed to unit, system, and user acceptance testing to improve release quality.
- Applied data science techniques for real-time anomaly detection and diagnosis of high-impact production problems.

Project #3: Wisestep ATS — Full Stack Engineer

Built and operated environments for a microservices-based recruitment platform handling partner-driven hiring workflows. Owned application security with OWASP and VAPT practices, containerization with Docker Swarm, CI/CD with Jenkins and Ansible, AWS IAM and parameter security, and day-to-day operations for Elasticsearch, Cassandra, and Kafka.

HTML, CSS, AngularJS, Bootstrap, Thymeleaf, Java, Spring MVC, Elasticsearch, Cassandra, Microservices, JHipster, AWS, Docker, Docker Swarm, NGINX, VAPT

Project #2: Wisestep Pulse — Full Stack Developer

Delivered a recruitment operations platform covering timesheets, contracts, and payments, with individual ownership across frontend, APIs, database design, and SQL performance tuning.

ASP.NET MVC, Entity Framework, C#, SQL Server 2008, AngularJS, HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, Gulp, Solr

Project #1: MIS — .NET Developer

Built and maintained an internal recruiting operations system with end-to-end ownership across feature delivery, release management, monitoring, troubleshooting, and IIS deployments.

ASP.NET Web Application, ASP.NET MVC, Entity Framework, C#, AngularJS, HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, Gulp, Solr, SQL Server 2008